

Katy Norris

PhD Candidate, Political Science
University College London
kathryn.norris.23@ucl.ac.uk

Education

University College London (UCL) Ph.D., Political Science - Dissertation: "The Politics of Mass Higher Education Provision" - Committee: Prof. Kristin M. Bakke, Prof. Tim Hicks, Prof. Zeynep Bulutgil	2023-2027
University of California, San Diego (UCSD) M.P.P., Inequality and Social Policy	2021- 2023
London School of Economics & Political Science M.Sc., Development Studies	2018-2019
Georgetown University B.S., International Politics	2012-2016

Research

Book chapters

Latin America's Education Systems in Comparative Perspective, 1945-2021: Patterns and Puzzles (with Agustina S. Paglayan). 2025. In J.A. Bogliaccini & A. Madariaga (Eds.), *Skills, Values, and Development: The Political Economy of Education in Latin America*. Oxford University Press.

Working papers

An education arms race? The political origins of mass higher education (Revise & resubmit).

Reconstruction or social control? Primary education provision in post-conflict Rwanda.

Selected works in progress

The political economy of education quality: Lessons from the "Finnish miracle" (with Agustina S. Paglayan).

Democracy under siege: Wartime restrictions and their legacies (with Kristin M. Bakke).

Teacher unions and women's political participation: Evidence from Greece (with Ioanna Gkoutna).

Grants & Awards

UCL Excellence in Student Feedback Award	2024, 2025, 2026
UCL Conference Grant (£1,500 total)	2024, 2025, 2026
UCL PhD Opportunity Fund (£1,500)	2025
UCL Departmental Research Fund (£2,500)	2025
UCL Clara Collet PhD Scholarship	2023-2027

UCSD Richard Covington Award for Empirical Research (\$1,000)	2023
UCSD Lawrence Scholarship	2021-2023
Mildred J. Robideau Scholarship for Academic Excellence	2012-2016

Presentations

2026: Council of European Studies Graduate Historical Workshop, UCL Comparative Political Economy & Behavior Workshop, UCL Conflict & Change PhD Workshop

2025: EPSA Annual Conference, APSA Education Politics & Policy Virtual Conference, UCL Comparative Political Economy & Behavior Workshop, UCL Conflict & Change Seminar, UCL Conflict & Change PhD Workshop

2024: APSA Annual Meeting, UCL Conflict & Change PhD Workshop

2023: APSA Annual Meeting

Teaching

Senior Postgraduate Teaching Assistant/Seminar Leader, UCL

- Evidence and Policy (graduate) 2026
- Quantitative Data Analysis (undergraduate) 2025
- Introduction to Politics, Sutton Trust Summer School (high school) 2025
- International Conflict & Cooperation (undergraduate) 2024, 2025

Writing Tutor, Academic Communication Centre, UCL

2025, 2026

- Student Evaluations: 4.9/5

Writing Tutor, School of Global Policy & Strategy, UCSD

2022, 2023

Research Assistance

Prof. Kristin M. Bakke, UCL 2025-2026

Prof. Agustina S. Paglayan, UCSD 2022-2023

Prof. Lei Guang, UCSD 2022

Professional Experience

Independent Consultant, Education Finance, Kaizenvest 2021-2023

Research Analyst, Research for Effective Education in Africa, Dexis Consulting Group 2018-2021

Strategy & Evaluation Coordinator, International Monetary Fund 2016-2018

Intern & Project Assistant, Center for Universal Education, The Brookings Institution 2015-2016

Selected Policy Research & Writing

Language of Instruction Country Profiles (with Rebecca Westbrook & Katie Smith). 2021. USAID.

School-Related Gender-Based Violence Measurement Toolkit (with Katie Smith & Stephanie Squires). 2020. USAID.

Soma Umenye Midterm Performance Evaluation (with Kristin Rosekrans, Michael Tusiime & Max Shanstrom). 2020. USAID.

Skills & Training

Languages: Spanish (proficient), Portuguese (beginner)

Software: MAXQDA, NVivo, QGIS, R, Stata

Additional Training: MethodsNET Comparative Historical Analysis Summer School

Service

Co-organizer, Departmental Research Seminar, UCL Political Science	2024-2026
PhD Admissions Analysis Project, DEI Committee, UCL Political Science	2024